

Prafulla Oimbe

Game Designer

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Professional Summary: Game Designer with 12+ years of experience across mobile F2P, casual, puzzle, and live-ops games, including work on titles such as Bejeweled Blitz, FarmVille 2, Deer Hunter Classic, and multiple games from concept to release. Skilled in designing gameplay systems, progression frameworks, economies, level/content structures and data-informed improvements that support player engagement and long-term retention. Familiar with Minecraft's core survival, crafting, exploration, progression and player motivation loops, with a strong interest in adapting its appeal into casual gameplay. Looking to bring strong design skills, player-focused gameplay and cross-functional leadership to King to help shape fun and satisfying casual gameplay experiences.

Experience Summary

- Worked on: Farmville 2, Bejeweled Blitz - Match 3 Puzzle, Deer Hunter Classic, Monopoly Slots, Chess Legends, Chess Blitz - Chess Puzzle, Fortnite UEFN Islands Creation.
- Game Design Lead: Led mobile games from concept through market release and live operations.
- Market Research: Conducted in-depth market research for game genres and competitor analysis, personas development.
- Leadership: Led various projects and mentored game designers, UX designer and UI artists. Directed a whole game division which consisted of Programmers, Artists (3D, Concept, Animators and VFX), Sound Designer, QA.
- Game Life Cycle: Experienced in designing games from scratch through release and live operations.
- Game System Design: Designed new game systems, designed and balanced game economy, fine-tuned mechanics using player feedback.
- Features and Level Design: Created new features, levels, and enhanced existing content.
- Design Documentation: Created detailed game design documents, design specifications, flowcharts, algorithms, game flows, presentations, and UI wireframes.
- Prototype and Innovation: Designed prototypes using Unity for new mechanics and features.
- Ideation and Brainstorming: Led and contributed to new games and feature ideas through collaborative brainstorming sessions.
- Data-Driven Design: Improved game features through data analysis for better player experience.
- Competitive Analysis: Evaluated competitors' games and features to inform decision-making.
- Collaboration: Collaborated with cross functional development teams, producers, and product owners to shape game vision and roadmaps.

Professional Roles and Responsibilities

Self-Employed

(Nov 2023 - Present)

- Building Fortnite experiences using UEFN.
- Published multiple Fortnite UEFN experiences with 5.3M+ minutes of playtime.
- Freelance Game Design Consultant for casual mobile games.

Game Director (Consultant), Pluto, Mumbai

(May 2024 - Aug 2024)

- Game Director for the new game development wing at Pluto, a blockchain studio under Plutoverse.
- Led and Defined the creative vision of the game to match the studio IP.
- Worked on an endless runner mobile game for an in-house IP, taking it from concept to playable prototype.
- Led a team of Artists (Concept Artists, 3D Modellers, Animators), Programmers, Sound Designer to deliver a unique vision for the studio IP.
- Designed game systems, mechanics, characters, bosses, and worlds to fit the IP.

Lead Game Designer, Super Huge Studios

(Apr 2021 - Sep 2023)

- Led three mobile game projects from ideation to release: two chess games and one solitaire game.
- Led and mentored Game Designers, UI artists and UX Designer.
- Created detailed game design documents and easy-to-understand design specifications.
- Defined the meta structure of the game and designed various systems including Arena Progression, Trophy System, Real-time Multiplayer, Matchmaking, Chat Systems, Inventory System etc.
- Designed the game economy from scratch and fine-tuned it iteratively.
- Brainstormed and prototyped innovative ideas, resulting in the successful implementation of new features.
- Conducted market and competitor analysis for new projects, leading to informed design decisions.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams, including programmers, artists and product managers, to bring ideas to life.
- Designed personas to guide product design and aligned game design accordingly.
- Facilitated player feedback sessions to gather valuable insights, effectively incorporating suggestions to enhance gameplay and optimize player experience.
- Analyzed player data to make better design decisions and improve the player experience.

Principal Game Designer, Freelance

(Feb 2020 - Mar 2021)

- Collaborated with German game studio Squeakosaurus as a Level Designer and Game Design Consultant for Pet Racing Rush+ KartRider Run
- Designed level layouts (greybox) for a wildlife exploration game for U.S. studio Take10 Animation
- Pitched new feature ideas to Imangi Studios and assisted XANSR Technologies in acquiring LiveOps rights for Temple Run 2 as a Principal Game Designer (Consultant)

Game Designer, Zynga Games

(Jun 2018 - Nov 2019)

- Led a team of designers to introduce a playable Tractor feature into FarmVille 2 on Facebook, revitalizing the game.
- Designed and implemented new game mechanics and features for improving KPIs: engagement, retention and monetization.
- Designed a collectible card game (CCG) system within Farmville 2.
- Utilized telemetry data for feature analysis and improvement.
- Collaborated with product managers on monetization strategies for existing and new features.
- Mentored and collaborated with junior designers in various game areas.

- Engaged with the community and incorporated player feedback into design decisions (via player polls on Facebook).

Game Designer, Glu Games

(May 2017 - May 2018)

- Designed and implemented new features and improvements for Deer Hunter Classic.
- Planned and executed content releases and seasonal in-game events.
- Created hundreds of hunting levels every month in Unity.
- Collaborated with other designers and product managers on game roadmap and feature planning.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to bring ideas to life.
- Balanced game economy of existing features and designed new game systems.
- Designed new events with seasonal themes and weapon designs.

Game Designer, EA Games

(Apr 2015 - Apr 2017)

- Designed new features and content for the match-3 puzzle (Bejeweled Blitz) and Casino Slots (Monopoly Slots) games.
- Collaborated with senior designers on new feature and game design documents.
- Participated in live operations for game improvements based on community feedback.
- Designed daily challenges and engaged players with seasonal content in Bejeweled Blitz.
- Designed new mechanics and Gems for Bejeweled Blitz brainstorming and rapid prototyping.
- Balanced and fine-tuned various game mechanics.
- Designed new slot machines and mechanics for Monopoly Slots.
- Worked on new thematic content for existing slot machines.
- Balanced slot machine economies by tuning RTP values.
- Designed new features such as the Jackpot and Daily Quests system.
- Utilized data analytics to optimize existing slot machines and improve engagement.

QA - Professional Experience

Sr QA Analyst, EA Games

(Jul 2010 to Mar 2015)

- Dev QA / Sr QA Analyst for in-house games, including FIFA, Monopoly Slots, Monopoly Bingo, The Sims Freeplay and Tetris Blitz on Android, iOS, J2ME, BREW and Facebook platforms.

QA Lead, Globalstep Services

(Jun 2009 to Jul 2010)

- Test Engineer/QA Lead for various Disney Studio projects such as Toy Story 3, Tron Evolution, Alice in Wonderland on PS3, Xbox 360, and Nintendo DS.

Skills

- Adept in Generative AI: Writing code for mechanics prototyping, high-quality image generation, concept art, UI and brainstorming for personal projects.
- Fortnite UEFN (Creative) island creation across different genres: Shooter, Racing, Zombie Roguelike, Deathrun, etc.

- Unreal Engine and Unity: Proficient in level design, building new mechanics with Blueprints and prototyping.
- Game Design and Mechanics: Proficient in game mechanics, system design, level design, game balancing and data-driven approaches.
- Game Live Operations: Well-versed in client and server-side features, user acquisition, engagement, monetization and player retention strategies.
- Game Genres: Experienced across different game genres, with a strong understanding of what makes games fun.
- Proficient in applying critical thinking skills to drive innovative game design solutions.
- Effective communicator: Adept at collaborating with cross-functional teams, conveying complex design concepts, and facilitating clear and concise communication throughout the game development process.
- Game Engines and Level Editors: Experience with Bethesda's Creation Kit for modding games like Skyrim and Fallout 4, as well as level editors for DOOM, FarCry, Fortnite and Portal.
- Tools and Software: Generative AI, Great at Excel, Photoshop, Miro, Microsoft Office Suite, Premier Pro, Adobe XD, Confluence, JIRA and video editing software.
- Hardware and Platforms: Proficient in PC hardware and experienced with different consoles and mobile/tablet devices.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Amravati University, India

- Bachelor's degree in Computer Science, with coursework in Mathematics and Physics.
- Strong understanding of computer technologies
- Basic knowledge of programming languages: C and C++

About Me

Passionate gamer and dedicated game designer with a deep appreciation for RPGs set in high fantasy realms. Proactively explores novel game mechanics and ideas while remaining up to date with industry trends and emerging technologies. Avid consumer of game articles, books, interviews, podcasts and development diaries to continuously expand knowledge and expertise. Fan of beloved franchises such as The Lord of the Rings and Star Wars. Outside of gaming, I find joy in embarking on forest treks and adventure expeditions, listening to StarTalk podcasts to expand my knowledge of science and space.